

Claim your GST

Remember to claim your 7 percent GST. You can do this at the airport by getting your bill receipt stamped by the customs department

Free advice

Always carry a laptop with you to test phone software and games before you purchase them

Travel to satisfy the geek in you

Usually people pick places to go based on what there is to do or see there. So where do geeks go on a holiday?

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Haven't we all been dragged out of malls and shops by friends or family, because we got so engrossed drooling over the spread of tech products on offer, that we lost count of hours?

Summer is usually the onset of the uncomfortable heat in India, and also the season for holidays. Now it's not like you can drag family and friends along on a geek holiday, so instead we tell you how geeks can have some fun at some of the most popular destinations across Asia.

SINGAPORE

Singapore is considered a shopper's paradise. Two major electronic attractions of the city are Sim Lim Square and Funan Digital Life mall. Sim Lim Square has seven stories of nothing but tech oozing out of every corner, and is spread over an area of 390,000 square feet. Rudresh, an ex-Digit writer from Singapore, says, "Come prepared to walk a lot, and

don't forget to bring your bargaining skills with you on your trip." The place is humongous, and you could spend days there without visiting the same shop twice. Most shops stack products from different vendors – making them a one stop shop for all your gadget needs. Consider this: you'll find 23 shops selling GPS devices and over 35 selling audio and video equipment. Remember, "shops" are not like our corner shops that sell mobiles, mice and keyboards, here they're actually more like Indian "showrooms".

Sim Lim Square sells Apple products for cheap, and Apple paraphernalia for even cheaper. It's also situated near Little India and is accessible via MRT which is the local train transit system of Singapore.

Another great destination to buy electronic products in Singapore is Funan Digital Life Mall. Considered an upmarket competitor of the Sim Lim Mall, the biggest tech shop here is Challenger Superstore which occupies almost the entire sixth floor of the mall and is operational 24 hours – perfect for that 3 AM craving for an NVIDIA GTX 590!

Another big store worth checking out here is Harvey Norman. Funan Digital Life mall also hosts regular promotional events and exhibitions for new product launches.

Tip: *Singapore is a little cheaper in terms of MP3 players, look for these.*

BANGKOK

Bangkok is another popular vacation spot, and although its popularity is not really because of tech, thankfully the locals are tech crazy enough to warrant some of the best shopping in South-East Asia.

Your first stop here should be Pantip Plaza, which is basically a mall dedicated to just tech. No clothes and shoes and other nonsense here.

You will find large stores from HP, Canon and Brother on the ground floor. The rest of the mall is filled with dealers that sell high-end computer gear, scanners, laptops, printers, etc. Data IT is a mini computer superstore on the second floor, and you'll find pretty much anything you need there.

The third floor is pirate heaven, and although as good Digitians we expect you to put on blinders and walk straight up to the fourth floor, something tells us you won't! You will get absolutely everything under the sun in terms of software and games here. The IT City is the entire fifth floor, and sells pre-built computers, and hosts exhibitions.

Digital Gateway is a four storied IT hub in Bangkok. You'll find



Masterchief gifts a copy of Halo Reach along with a Halo Xbox controller to a contest winner at Funan Digital Life mall, Singapore

all the latest gadgets and IT related exhibitions happening here. Most big technology brands have stores here, including Samsung, Sony and Fujitsu. Of course, you will also find independent IT dealers here as well.

Also check out Fortune Town IT Mall which offers friendlier services than Pantip Plaza, and if you're looking for some family time out topped with some electronic shopping then head to MBK Center.

Tips: *Look for shops where Thai people are buying stuff from, chances are you'll find the best bargain deals there.*

For those who don't want pirated stuff, Digital Gateway is the place to be.

PLAN YOUR TRAVEL AROUND THESE EVENTS

Where: Australia

What: CeBIT Australia 2011

When: May 31st to June 2nd

Where: Taiwan

What: Computex 2011

When: May 31st to June 4th

Where: Hong Kong

What: Hong Kong electronic fair

When: October 13th to 16th

Where: Singapore

What: SITEX IT Show

When: November 24th to 27th